5.3.1 Returning status codes with Results and TypedResults

A well-designed API uses status codes to indicate to a client what went wrong when a request failed, as well as potentially provide more descriptive codes when a request is successful. You should anticipate common problems that may occur when clients call your API and return appropriate status codes to indicate the causes to users.

ASP.NET Core exposes the simple `static` helper types `Results` and `TypedResults` in the namespace `Microsoft.AspNetCore.Http`. You can use these helpers to create a response with common status codes, optionally including a JSON body. Each of the methods on `Results` and `TypedResults` returns an implementation of `IResult`, which the endpoint middleware executes to generate the final response.

NOTE `Results` and `TypedResults` perform the same function, as helpers for generating common status codes. The only difference is that the `Results` methods return an `IResult`, whereas `TypedResults` return a concrete generic type, such as `Ok<T>`. There's no difference in terms of functionality, but the generic types are easier to use in unit tests and in OpenAPI documentation, as you'll see in chapters 36 and 11. `TypedResults` were added in .NET 7.

The following listing shows an updated version of listing 5.2, in which we address some of the deficiencies in the API and use `Results` and `TypedResults` to return different status codes to clients.

Listing 5.3 Using `Results` and `TypedResults` in a minimal API